Bartholomew Achterberg

Staff Platform Engineer

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SUMMARY

Staff platform engineer with seventeen years in infrastructure. I set technical direction for a platform group of 22 people and still write code weekly. Kubernetes, Terraform and CI/CD are the core of what we provide; reliability, security and cost are what we are judged on. I spend as much time on people and priorities as on code: hiring, writing design documents and saying no to shiny things that would not help our users. I speak regularly at European infrastructure conferences.

SKILLS

Kubernetes, Terraform, CI/CD, AWS, Go, Cilium, Argo CD, Vault, Crossplane, Prometheus, Thanos, Linux, Architecture

EXPERIENCE

Staff Platform Engineer, Tulpen Marketplace 2018 – Present

- Architected a multi-region Kubernetes platform running 600 services and 4,000 pods at peak.
- Maintain 300 Terraform modules with automated testing and a registry that every team consumes.
- Designed the company-wide CI/CD standard, reducing median lead time for change from nine days to under four hours.
- Drove the adoption of Cilium and eBPF-based observability.
- Coach senior engineers and write the platform roadmap.
- Defined the on-call policy and training path, reducing out-of-hours pages per engineer by 60% over two years.
- Negotiated cloud commitments with finance and saved roughly 1.2 million euros annually.

Senior DevOps Engineer, Grachten Booking BV 2013 – 2018

- Led the move from data-centre hosting to AWS for a travel booking site.
- Introduced Terraform and replaced manual change tickets with reviewed pull requests.
- Built early Docker-based deployment tooling.
- Mentored three engineers into senior roles.
- Built a deployment dashboard showing lead time, change failure rate and recovery time per team.

Systems Engineer, Zuiderzee Hosting 2009 – 2013

- Ran shared hosting and virtual private servers on Linux.
- Automated provisioning with Puppet and Bash.
- Learned the value of boring technology and written runbooks.

EDUCATION

- MSc Computer Science, Technische Universiteit Oostmark (2007 – 2009)

LANGUAGES

Dutch (native), English (fluent), German (B2)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Kubernetes Administrator

- HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate